



Coming down the mountain

The return of cows from the Alps is celebrated in August. It is called the Einabtrieb. The cows are usually decorated in bright colors. But if somebody has died, the decorations are black or dark blue.



Very Viennese

One in five Austrians lives in Vienna, the capital of Austria. The city was once at the center of the great Austro-Hungarian empire. It is still an important city, and is the home of many United Nations organizations.

Four languages

Switzerland is surrounded by Germany, Austria, Liechtenstein, France, and Italy. The languages spoken in Switzerland are French, German, Italian, and Romansh.

Most Swiss people speak German, but many speak at least two of these languages.



Austria



Germany



Liechtenstein



Switzerland



Snowy holiday

Every year, thousands of skiers visit resorts in Austria and Switzerland. Some people worry that mountain tourism spoils the environment. But it brings lots of money for both countries and is a big employer of local people.



The highest point of the wheel is nearly 213 feet (65 meters) above the ground.

Each carriage takes up to 12 passengers.

The biggest wheel

The Riesenrad in Vienna is one of the largest big wheels in the world. The wheel is 200 feet (61 meters) across, and it goes around at 30 inches (75 centimeters) per second.

